



A MEMBER RESOURCE • NO. 03

Nutrition *Basics.*

A short, calm guide to eating for a healthier life, written for every member training with us at Gain. No fads, no calorie maths, no shame.

Start here READ THIS FIRST

Eat for a *healthier life.*

What you eat is one of the biggest things that shapes how you feel day to day: your energy, your mood, your sleep, and how well you recover between sessions. This guide is not about eating perfectly. It is about eating a bit better, most of the time, in a way you can actually keep up.

Here is how we would like you to think about it. There are **no bad foods, only bad habits**. Get your everyday eating right and you can still enjoy the pizza and the pudding now and then, without a shred of guilt. The best results we see, by a distance, come from members who simply follow a few basic principles and stick with them. That is all this guide is.

“You don’t need a perfect diet. You need one that works for you as an individual, repeated for years.”

HALLUM COUSINS · HEAD COACH, GAIN

IN THIS GUIDE

- 01 Protein
- 02 Carbohydrates
- 03 Fat loss & body composition
- 04 Hydration & timing
- 05 Seven meals to lean on

WHO THIS IS FOR

Members in their first weeks.

Training once, twice or three times a week with us. This covers the fundamentals; nothing more complicated than that.

IF YOU TAKE ONE THING

A palm of protein, every meal.

The rule that does the most work. Everything else is icing on the cake.

No. 01 PROTEIN

Build with *protein.*

Strength training is a request your muscles make for repair. Protein is the material they repair with. Get enough of it, consistently, and the work you put in at the studio actually shows up.



A SPREAD OF SIMPLE PROTEIN SOURCES

A • WHY



It's the repair material.

Every session creates tiny amounts of damage in the muscle. Protein gives your body the building blocks to repair it, a little stronger than before. Without enough, the work does not stick.

B • HOW MUCH



A palm-sized portion, each meal.

Aim for roughly the size and thickness of your own palm at every main meal. Across three meals a day, that lands most adults in a good place. No weighing required.

C • WHEN



Spread it across the day.

A palm at breakfast, lunch and dinner beats one large portion at night. Steady, even feeding keeps repair switched on. Snacks count too: yoghurt, nuts, a boiled egg.

Simple sources *we'd put on the list.*

- 01 Chicken, turkey, lean beef, lamb:** palm-sized, any cooking method.
- 02 Salmon, mackerel, tuna, white fish:** fresh or tinned, both fine.
- 03 Eggs:** two or three is a portion, scrambled, boiled or poached.
- 04 Greek yoghurt, cottage cheese, milk:** useful between meals.
- 05 Lentils, beans, chickpeas, tofu:** pair two for a full portion.
- 06 Whey or plant protein shake:** handy when cooking isn't realistic.

No. 02 CARBOHYDRATES

Fuel, not the *enemy*.

Carbohydrates have taken a beating in recent years, but they are your body's main source of energy. Used well, they are genuinely good for you: they fuel your sessions and help you recover. The trick is choosing the right ones most of the time.



QUALITY CARBS, MOST DAYS

GOOD EVERYDAY CHOICES

- Oats, wholegrain bread, brown rice
- Potatoes and sweet potatoes
- Wholemeal pasta
- Fruit of every kind
- Beans, lentils and chickpeas

USING THEM WELL

Include some carbohydrate in the meal **before** you train; it gives you the energy to train well. Pair carbs with protein **after** training and they help your muscles recover.

A fist-sized portion alongside your palm of protein is a solid default at most meals. Training hard most days? Lean towards the higher end. Taking it easy or resting? Scale it back a little; your body simply needs less fuel that day.

Enjoying less nutritious carbs now and then is completely fine. It is relying on them every day that causes problems, not the occasional treat.

No. 03 FAT LOSS & BODY COMPOSITION

Fat loss, the *calm way*.

If losing body fat is one of your goals, this page is for you. If it is not, feel free to skip ahead. The approach is simple, and there is no calorie counting involved.

Eat a little less than usual **without going hungry**, keep your protein high so your muscle is protected, and keep training. In practice that means slightly smaller portions, or one fewer snack across the day. Nothing dramatic: slow, steady change sticks far better than a crash diet.

It is completely normal *not* to lose much on the scales while you are building muscle.

This is body recomposition, and it is a good sign. You can be losing fat and gaining muscle at the same time. Because muscle is denser than fat, the scales may hold steady, or even nudge up, while your body is genuinely changing for the better.

BETTER WAYS TO MEASURE PROGRESS

- ✓ How your **clothes** fit
- ✓ Your **energy** and how you feel day to day
- ✓ How much **stronger** you are getting
- ✓ What your **coach** notices in how you move



SMALL CHANGES, MADE OFTEN

No. 04 HYDRATION & TIMING

Hydration, and *timing*.

Two small things that quietly make everything else work better. Neither needs a supplement, a gadget or a spreadsheet.

HYDRATION

Even mild dehydration takes the edge off your strength, focus and recovery. The fix is unglamorous: keep a bottle nearby and refill it. Tea, coffee, squash and milk all count towards the total; alcohol does not. Pale, straw-coloured by mid-afternoon means you are roughly there.

2 to 3_LPER DAY, FROM ALL
DRINKS**+500_{ml}**EXTRA ON TRAINING
DAYS**3×**

REFILL A 750 ML BOTTLE

EATING AROUND YOUR SESSION

You do not need supplements or a pre-workout. A normal meal an hour or two before, and another within a few hours after, does the job.

2 HRS BEFORE**A balanced meal**

Protein and slow carbs. Porridge with yoghurt, a chicken sandwich, or eggs on toast.

30 MIN BEFORE**Optional top-up**

A banana, a few dates, a slice of toast. Skip it if your last meal was recent.

DURING**Sip water**

Around 250 to 500 ml across the session. No sports drink needed for our length of session.

1 TO 2 HRS AFTER**Protein and carbs**

A real meal, ideally. Salmon and rice, chilli and potato, or a yoghurt and fruit bowl.

No. 05 SEVEN MEALS

Seven meals to *lean on*.

Each one is a palm of protein, a fist of carbs, a thumb of fat, and something colourful. Mix and rotate: boring is reliable.

No. 01

BREAKFAST

Greek yoghurt & berry bowl

Full-fat Greek yoghurt, a handful of berries, a scatter of oats, a drizzle of honey. Five minutes, no cooking.

PRE-TRAINING FRIENDLY

No. 02

BREAKFAST

Eggs on sourdough

Three eggs, scrambled or poached, on two slices of sourdough. Wilted spinach or a sliced tomato on the side.

PRE-TRAINING FRIENDLY

No. 03

LUNCH

Tinned salmon salad bowl

Tinned salmon over leaves, cucumber, cherry tomatoes, half an avocado, a hard-boiled egg, olive oil and lemon.

QUICK · 8 MIN

No. 04

LUNCH

Chicken & hummus wrap

Sliced cooked chicken, a thick layer of hummus, grated carrot and rocket in a wholemeal wrap. A piece of fruit alongside.

PORTABLE

No. 05

DINNER

Sheet-pan salmon & veg

Salmon fillet with broccoli, peppers and new potatoes, roasted on one tray with olive oil and lemon. 25 minutes, one wash-up.

POST-TRAINING

No. 06

DINNER

Slow-cooker chilli & rice

Lean beef mince, kidney beans, tinned tomatoes, onion and chilli powder. Cooks itself, freezes well, feeds you twice.

BATCH · 4 PORTIONS

No. 07

SNACK · BETWEEN MEALS

A handful of nuts & an apple, or a glass of milk & a banana

Snacks are not the enemy. The right ones, a small protein with a small carb, take the edge off and stop you arriving at dinner ravenous. Cottage cheese on rye, a boiled egg or plain Greek yoghurt all fit the bill.

MID-MORNING · MID-AFTERNOON · PRE-BED

Before you go AN IMPORTANT NOTE

General guidance, not *medical advice*.

We are personal trainers and coaches, not registered nutritionists or dietitians. This guide is general guidance built from common, mainstream advice: a sensible place to start for most healthy adults training with us.

If you have a diagnosed condition, are pregnant, are taking medication that interacts with food, or have a history of disordered eating, please speak to your GP, dietitian or specialist before changing anything. We are happy to liaise with them.

NEED A HAND?

Bring it up *at your check-in*.

Your Week 4 or Week 6 phone call is the right place to talk through what is working and what is not. No pressure; we will keep it practical.

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

- ✓ A **palm of protein** at every main meal
- ✓ A **fist of quality carbs**, matched to your day
- ✓ **Two to three litres** of fluid a day, more on training days
- ✓ Eat before you train; **protein and carbs** after
- ✓ Pick a few **repeatable meals** and rotate them
- ✓ Don't aim for perfect. Aim for **most weeks, most meals**.